

FLAGSHIP PROGRAM

TEQUILA ACCELERATOR

*Market Entry Program for Mexican Tequila & Spirits Companies
Entering the Indian Market*

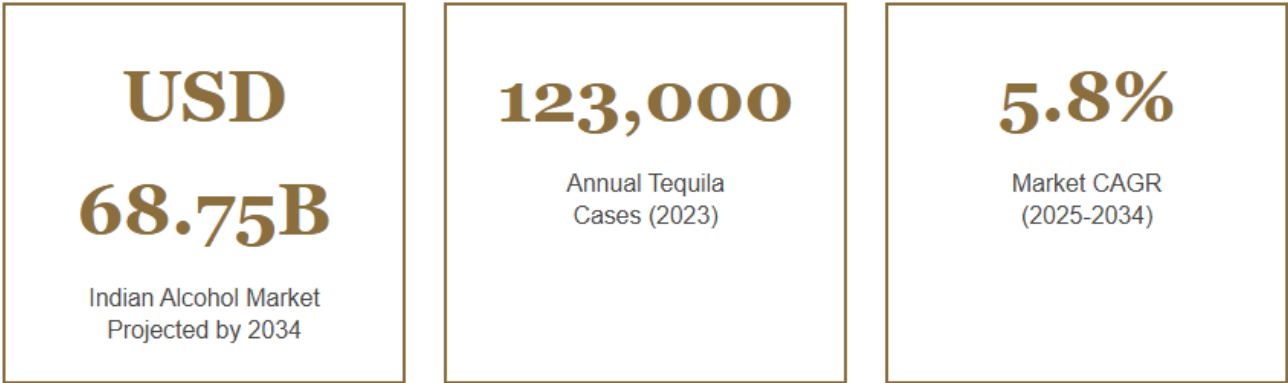
A comprehensive facilitation program designed to establish Mexican tequila and mezcal brands in India's rapidly growing premium spirits market—from regulatory navigation through distribution establishment and brand launch.

MÉXICO–INDIA BUSINESS COUNCIL

The Institutional Platform for Bilateral Trade & Investment

The Opportunity

India represents one of the world's fastest-growing premium spirits markets, yet Mexican tequila and mezcal remain significantly under-represented—creating a substantial market entry opportunity for Mexican producers.



Market Dynamics

India is the fifth largest player in the global alcohol beverage market. The Indian Alcohol Beverage Industry is estimated to grow from USD 39.30 billion in 2024 to USD 68.75 billion by 2034, representing a compound annual growth rate of 5.8% (CAGR 2025-2034). This expansion is driven by rising disposable incomes, growing urbanization, and increasing social acceptance of premium spirits consumption among young professionals.

Consumer Preferences

- ▶ **Blanco/White/Silver tequila** most preferred in Indian market
- ▶ Both 100% agave and Mixtos (51% agave) perform well
- ▶ Fast-moving bottle sizes: 180ml and 750ml
- ▶ Retail price range: USD 26–79
- ▶ Growing premium spirits segment driven by young, urban consumers

México's Export Strength

- ▶ México is the 3rd largest exporter of alcoholic beverages globally
- ▶ Total alcohol exports: approximately USD 5.85 billion
- ▶ Significant exporter of tequila and mezcal with steady growth
- ▶ Global tequila market growing at 12.1% CAGR (2025-2033)
- ▶ Strategic positioning to serve India's expanding premium market

Import Activity & Market Penetration

According to India's import data, India imported **14,979 shipments of tequila** during the trailing twelve months, supplied by foreign exporters to 304 Indian buyers. Despite this activity, Mexican brands remain underrepresented, with significant room for market development through structured entry programs.

The Challenge

India's alcoholic beverages market is among the world's most complex regulatory environments. Each of India's 28 states and 8 union territories operates under distinct excise regimes—requiring sophisticated local knowledge and institutional relationships to navigate successfully.

Regulatory Landscape

Import & Taxation

- 150% standard import duty on spirits
- State excise duty: 30% to over 100% (varies by state)
- Additional levies: sales tax, bottling fee, liter fee, vend fee, privilege fee
- FL-I Foreign Liquor Marketing License required

State-Level Variability

- **Open Markets:** Maharashtra, Goa, Odisha, J&K
- **Auction Markets:** UP, Rajasthan, MP, Bihar, Punjab
- **Government Control:** Tamil Nadu, Karnataka, Kerala, Delhi
- **Prohibited:** Gujarat, Manipur, Mizoram, Nagaland

Labeling & Compliance

- Standards and Weight and Measures (Packaged Commodities) Rules, 1977
- Mandatory declarations: manufacturer details, net quantity, MRP, manufacturing date
- State-specific label requirements and Guala cap mandates

Marketing Restrictions

- Television and print advertising prohibited since 2008
- Limited to point-of-sale materials, events, and sponsorships
- Surrogate advertising strategies required
- Social media emerging as key channel (currently unregulated)

The Market Entry Barrier

Without established local networks, institutional relationships with state excise departments, and deep knowledge of India's fragmented regulatory environment, Mexican tequila brands face significant barriers to successful market entry. The Tequila Accelerator eliminates these barriers through institutional facilitation and operational handholding.

The Solution

The Tequila Accelerator is MIBC's flagship program designed to facilitate market entry for Mexican tequila and spirits brands in India—providing end-to-end support from initial market assessment through brand launch and distribution establishment.

What We Deliver

The Tequila Accelerator collapses typical 18–24 month market entry timelines into a focused 2–3 month accelerated execution program. By leveraging MIBC's government relationships, distributor networks, and operational expertise, participating brands gain rapid market access with reduced risk and investment.

Program Structure

The program operates across four integrated service pillars, each designed to address specific market entry challenges while building toward commercial launch:

1. Market Intelligence

- Indian spirits market landscape and competitive analysis
- Consumer segmentation and preference mapping
- Pricing strategy development for Indian market positioning
- Target channel identification (HoReCa, retail, e-commerce)
- State-by-state market opportunity assessment

2. Regulatory Navigation

- State-by-state licensing requirements and compliance roadmap
- Import documentation and customs procedures
- Labeling and packaging compliance guidance
- Excise registration and ongoing compliance support
- Liaison with state excise departments

3. Distribution Development

- Curated introductions to leading importers and distributors
- Hospitality partner connections (premium hotels, bars, restaurants)
- First-client facilitation and handholding
- Contract negotiation support and partnership structuring
- Channel partner performance monitoring

4. Brand Launch Support

- Launch event coordination in key metros (Mumbai, Delhi, Bangalore)
- Trade and consumer outreach programs
- Media and influencer connections
- Ongoing market development and expansion support
- Performance tracking and optimization

Timeline & Deliverables

Accelerated 2–3 Month Program Structure

Unlike traditional market entry consultancies that require 18–24 months, the Tequila Accelerator delivers focused, outcome-driven execution in 2–3 months through MIBC's institutional networks and pre-established relationships.

Weeks 1–3: Market Assessment & Strategy

- ▶ **Comprehensive Market Report:** India spirits market overview, tequila category analysis, competitive landscape, and consumer insights
- ▶ **State-Level Opportunity Matrix:** Priority state identification based on market size, regulatory complexity, and entry barriers
- ▶ **Pricing & Positioning Strategy:** Recommended retail pricing, channel strategy, and competitive positioning framework
- ▶ **Regulatory Compliance Roadmap:** State-by-state licensing requirements, documentation checklists, and compliance timelines

Weeks 4–6: Partner Identification & Engagement

- ▶ **Distributor Shortlist:** Curated list of 8–10 qualified importers/distributors with track records in premium spirits
- ▶ **Facilitated Introductions:** Organized meetings with shortlisted partners, including MIBC-led presentations and due diligence support
- ▶ **Partnership Negotiation:** Contract review, commercial terms negotiation, and partnership structuring advisory
- ▶ **Hospitality Partnerships:** Introductions to premium hotels, restaurants, and bars for initial placement

Weeks 7–10: Regulatory Execution & Launch Preparation

- ▶ **License Applications:** FL-I license applications filed in priority states with MIBC liaison support
- ▶ **Import Documentation:** Complete import paperwork, customs clearance coordination, and first shipment facilitation
- ▶ **Label Approvals:** State-specific label designs submitted and approved across target markets
- ▶ **Launch Event Planning:** Brand launch event design, venue selection, guest list development, and media coordination

Weeks 11–12: Market Launch

- ▶ **Brand Launch Events:** Execution of launch events in Mumbai, Delhi, and Bangalore with trade and media presence
- ▶ **Channel Activation:** Point-of-sale materials deployment, staff training coordination, and promotional campaign launch
- ▶ **Media & Influencer Engagement:** Press releases, social media campaigns, and influencer partnerships
- ▶ **Post-Launch Advisory:** 3-month advisory support for performance optimization and market expansion planning

Program Duration

Core Program: 2–3 months from engagement through market launch

Post-Launch Support: 3-month advisory retainer included for market development and regulatory monitoring

Extended Advisory: Optional annual retainer available for continued expansion support

Why MIBC?

The México–India Business Council is the first dedicated bilateral business council for the México–India corridor headquartered in India. Established with the support of the Government of México, MIBC provides institutional-grade facilitation that traditional consultants and distributors cannot replicate.

Our Distinction

Government Relationships

MIBC maintains direct working relationships with the Consulate General of México in Mumbai, Indian state excise departments, and trade promotion agencies in both nations. When MIBC makes an introduction or regulatory submission, it carries institutional weight that accelerates approvals and partnerships.

Bilateral Expertise

Our CEO, Ravi K. Tiwari, brings 15 years of bilateral trade and investment leadership—having represented both the Government of México (ProMéxico India, 2011–2015) and the Government of Canada (Trade Commissioner, Ontario, 2015–2025) in India. This dual government experience provides unmatched understanding of how institutional trade promotion operates on both sides of the corridor.

Operational Networks

MIBC's networks extend across Indian importers, premium hospitality operators, modern retail chains, e-commerce platforms, and state-level industry associations. These relationships—built over 15 years of government service and private sector advisory—provide participating brands with qualified introductions and expedited market access.

Outcome Orientation

MIBC measures success by transactions facilitated, partnerships established, and market access secured—not by reports delivered or events hosted. Every engagement is structured toward commercial outcomes, with clear milestones and accountability throughout the program lifecycle.

Track Record

MIBC's leadership has facilitated over **USD 500 million in qualified investment leads** across India, México, and Canada—spanning automotive, pharmaceuticals, IT services, and agri-food sectors. The Tequila Accelerator applies this same operational rigor and institutional access to Mexican spirits market entry.

Program Investment

The Tequila Accelerator is offered as a structured engagement with transparent deliverables and milestone-based execution. Program fees are tailored to brand size, target market scope, and required level of support.

For detailed program terms, investment requirements, and enrollment process, please contact MIBC directly.

NEXT STEPS

Get Started

Ready to establish your brand in India's growing premium spirits market? MIBC's Tequila Accelerator provides the institutional support, regulatory expertise, and commercial networks required for successful market entry in just 2–3 months.

Enrollment Process

Step 1: Initial Consultation

Schedule an introductory call with MIBC's leadership team to discuss your brand, market entry objectives, and program fit.

Step 2: Brand Assessment

MIBC conducts preliminary market assessment and develops customized program scope aligned with your brand positioning and target markets.

Step 3: Program Agreement

Review detailed program deliverables, timelines, and investment terms. Execute program agreement and initiate market entry planning.

Step 4: Market Entry Execution

MIBC commences full-service market entry support—from regulatory navigation through distribution establishment and brand launch.